

Agentic AI for State & Local Government

FROM SCATTERED PILOTS TO A GOVERNED AI PLATFORM

A complete, deployable reference library: eight production-shaped agents across the resident journey, all built on one governed platform where every consequential action stays human, every answer is cited, and every step is logged — designed for a regulated environment from day one.

THE PROBLEM

- Pilots are everywhere; few reach governed, funded production.
- Each agent rebuilt from scratch multiplies cost and risk.
- Security, accessibility and audit are bolted on late, if at all.
- Residents experience government as disconnected silos.

90% vs 25% piloting GenAI vs. funded to scale it (NASCIO 2025)

\$100B+ government IT spend, ~80% operating legacy systems (GAO)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1 Resident-facing
- 2 Casework
- 3 Operations
- ✓ Human gates everywhere (*human gate*)
- 5 One platform

Each agent withholds its consequential action — issue, adjudicate, release, award — verified by tests.

THE ROI

8 agents each with code, IaC, containers, runbooks and a customer deck

CFN + Terraform full IaC parity across commercial and GovCloud

WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility tested; control mappings included

Executive case: Lead with the agent that fits the room — 311 for citizen value, benefits for mission, public safety for credibility — then sell the platform underneath. Build governance once and every future agent inherits it. That is the difference between another pilot and a fundable program.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Identity & least privilege — Cognito + custom:slg_role; deny-by-default MCP gateway; effective scope = agent grant $\cap$ user entitlement.

Data protection — PII masking before inference; KMS encryption; S3 Object Lock (WORM) audit; private VPC + Bedrock VPC endpoint.

AI guardrails & HITL — Bedrock Guardrails; grounded, cited answers; consequential action withheld in code until a human approves.

Compliance posture — Bedrock FedRAMP High + DoD IL-4/5 in GovCloud; CJIS / IRS-1075 alignment; CloudTrail; ADA WCAG 2.1 AA.

Deploy: Standalone (own VPC/edge/identity/data/WORM audit) or + Whole-of-Government layer. Full CloudFormation + Terraform parity, commercial & GovCloud (US).

Resident Services & 311 Virtual Agent

FROM \$8 A CALL TO \$0.10

An always-on, multilingual agent that answers resident questions, files and tracks 311 service requests, and routes only the exceptions to staff — grounded in your knowledge base, with every answer cited and every action logged.

THE PROBLEM

- The same FAQs — trash days, permits, potholes, payments — consume scarce agent time.
- Live channels cost roughly \$8 a contact; self-service is about a dime.
- After-hours and language gaps push residents to call back, inflating volume.
- Staff copy-paste between systems instead of resolving the resident's actual issue.

\$8.01 per live-agent contact — ~80× the cost of self-service (Gartner, 2019)

98,028 / day contact volume at a single big-city 311 (NYC OTI, 2023)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

1 Understand the request

2 Ground the answer

3 Take the safe action

 **Human gate** (*human gate*)

5 Log & learn

Read and file-a-request are automated; commitments are not. The agent drafts; a person commits.

THE ROI

2,700 inquiries handled in month one, North Carolina DES assistant

~20% of all 311 interactions handled by Denver's 'Sunny' assistant

45% peak-season live-agent staffing reduction, Denver

Executive case: Every contact the agent resolves is roughly an \$8 live interaction turned into a dime — at 311 volumes that is a budget line, not a rounding error. Productivity research shows the biggest lift goes to your newest agents, shortening ramp time and turnover cost.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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Forms & Intelligent Document Processing

FROM 45 MINUTES TO 20 SECONDS

An IDP agent that ingests applications, letters, and voicemails, extracts and validates the fields, masks PII, and routes a clean record to staff — replacing manual keying that is slow and error-prone, with a human gate before anything is filed as official.

THE PROBLEM

- Basic applications can wait weeks or months just to be entered.
- Manual keying introduces errors that cause rejected applications and rework.
- Documents arrive in every format — typed, handwritten, scanned, voicemail.
- Staff spend their first hour on a case transcribing, not deciding.

~1%+ field error rate for manual entry — higher for single-key (JAMIA, 2019)

45 min manual intake per case before staff can begin (Anne Arundel County)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1** Ingest anything
- 2** Extract & summarize
- 3** Validate & mask
-  **Human confirm** (*human gate*)
- 5** File & audit

Extraction is automated; the official record of truth is human-confirmed before it enters the case system.

THE ROI

45 min → <20s intake summarization time, Anne Arundel County 'GIST' on AWS

Near-zero manual effort on tasks that once took close to an hour

Bedrock + Textract + Transcribe + Guardrails + human-in-the-loop, in production

Executive case: Reclaim the first hour of every case. Staff move from transcription to judgment, applications clear faster, and the ~1% manual-entry error tax — and the rework it causes downstream — largely disappears. The same pipeline feeds every other agent in this library.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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Permitting & Licensing Plan-Review Agent

FROM WEEKS AND MONTHS TO HOURS AND DAYS

An AI plan-review assistant that checks designs against local zoning and building codes before submission, flags issues for applicants to fix up front, and gives reviewers a structured first pass — so staff approve, not chase corrections. The issuance decision stays with a licensed human.

THE PROBLEM

- Reviewers manually check each plan against zoning and building codes.
- Incomplete submissions bounce back, adding correction cycles and weeks.
- Applicants wait without visibility; staff field status calls.
- Permitting delay shows up directly in the price of housing and development.

Weeks-months to issue rebuilding permits at the local pace California flagged as too slow

>26% share of a new single-family home's price driven by regulation (NAHB)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1 Pre-check the plan
- 2 Flag for the applicant
- 3 Structure the review
- ✓ Human issues the permit (*human gate*)
- 5 Record & audit

The agent accelerates the review; a licensed human issues the permit. Issuance is withheld in code.

THE ROI

Weeks → hours/days permit process with AI e-check, per the Governor of California

~50% zoning-review time saved with AI pre-check, City of Austin

25+ municipalities already using AI plan-review (Austin, Houston, Seattle, CO...)

Executive case: Every correction cycle removed is days off the clock for a resident or a builder — and permitting delay is a measurable housing cost. The agency keeps the same legal authority and reviewer judgment, but spends it on decisions instead of chasing incomplete paperwork.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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Benefits & HHS Caseworker Copilot

FROM HOURS TO MINUTES

A caseworker copilot that prescreens eligibility, drafts notices, explains requirements to applicants, and surfaces the documents a case is missing — so fewer people lose coverage over paperwork. Every adjudication stays a human decision.

THE PROBLEM

- Most coverage losses are procedural — missed forms, not actual ineligibility.
- Payment error rates carry federal corrective-action consequences.
- Call centers back up; applicants give up before reaching a human.
- Caseworkers spend time chasing documents instead of adjudicating.

10.93% SNAP FY2024 payment error rate; 44 states required to file corrective plans (USDA)

69% of unwinding disenrollments procedural, not eligibility (KFF, Sept 2024)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1 Prescreen eligibility
- 2 Explain to the applicant
- 3 Draft the work product
- ✓ Human adjudicates (*human gate*)
- 5 Record & audit

Prescreen and draft are automated; adjudication is withheld in code until a caseworker decides.

THE ROI

Hours → ~5 min to draft an unemployment-appeal ruling, Nevada DETR

>10,000 → cleared appeals backlog targeted by AI triage, Nevada

993,141 sessions handled by Georgia DOL's 'George' assistant, 97% routed accurately

Executive case: If most coverage losses are procedural, the highest-ROI move isn't stricter review — it's helping eligible people complete their paperwork. Faster prescreening and drafting clear backlogs and reduce error-driven federal penalties, while a human still owns every benefit decision.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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Public Records & FOIA Response Agent

FROM A 267,056-REQUEST BACKLOG TO SECONDS OF SEARCH

An agent that searches records, proposes redactions with cited exemptions, and assembles response packages — turning hours of manual review into seconds — while a records officer reviews and authorizes every release.

THE PROBLEM

- Backlogs grow as requests outpace staff capacity.
- Redaction is slow, manual, and unforgiving of error.
- Records sit across systems with no unified search.
- Statutory clocks run while reviewers work line by line.

267,056 backlogged requests, up 33% over the prior year (DOJ OIP, FY2024)

\$723.4M total government-wide FOIA cost in FY2024 (DOJ OIP)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1 Search the records
- 2 Propose redactions
- 3 Assemble the package
- ✓ Human authorizes release (*human gate*)
- 5 Record & audit

The agent proposes; a records officer disposes. No record is released until a human authorizes it.

THE ROI

Hours → seconds county records search with Kofile on AWS, 3,000+ counties served

85% faster redaction automation, CaseGuard (vendor claim)

3,000+ county governments already modernizing records search on AWS

Executive case: Backlogs and statutory-deadline risk are the exposure. Compressing search and first-pass redaction from hours to seconds lets a fixed team clear far more requests on time — while a records officer still authorizes every release, so speed never becomes an unauthorized disclosure.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Identity & least privilege — Cognito + custom:slg_role; deny-by-default MCP gateway; effective scope = agent grant $\cap$ user entitlement.

Data protection — PII masking before inference; KMS encryption; S3 Object Lock (WORM) audit; private VPC + Bedrock VPC endpoint.

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Procurement & Grants Drafting Agent

FROM 57-DAY RFP CYCLES TO FASTER, BETTER-WRITTEN AWARDS

An agent that drafts solicitations, checks them for completeness before they post, and assembles evaluation materials — compressing the writing burden — while award decisions stay with human evaluators and the audit trail stays intact.

THE PROBLEM

- Drafting a solicitation consumes dozens of staff hours.
- Cycles stretch to two months from posting to award.
- Most RFPs draw only a few bids, weakening competition.
- Manual evaluation is hard to keep consistent and auditable.

57 days average RFP cycle, posting to award (Euna analysis of 6,000+ RFPs)

~90 hrs average staff effort per RFP project (Euna / NCPP 2024 data)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

1 Draft the solicitation

2 Check before posting

3 Assemble evaluation aids

 **Human awards** (*human gate*)

5 Record & audit

The agent drafts and organizes; humans evaluate and award. Award is withheld in code.

THE ROI

\$6.8B purchasing inefficiencies flagged by Oklahoma OMES procurement AI

All spend, 60 days Oklahoma reviewed all state procurement vs. ~8 audits/year before

8 hrs / week saved per worker in Pennsylvania's AI pilot (procurement a named use case)

Executive case: Named states are turning AI on procurement into hard dollars: Oklahoma flagged \$6.8B in inefficiencies and reviewed all state spend in 60 days. This agent applies the same governed pattern to the writing burden — faster, more complete solicitations and more competition — while evaluation and award stay human and every version is logged for protest defense.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Identity & least privilege — Cognito + custom:slg_role; deny-by-default MCP gateway; effective scope = agent grant $\cap$ user entitlement.

Data protection — PII masking before inference; KMS encryption; S3 Object Lock (WORM) audit; private VPC + Bedrock VPC endpoint.

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GovOps IT Service Desk Agent

FROM TICKET QUEUES TO 75% SELF-RESOLVED

An internal IT agent that answers common employee questions, resets and unblocks the routine cases, and prepares higher-risk runbooks for an engineer to execute — so staff get help instantly and engineers focus on real incidents. High-risk actions require an approver.

THE PROBLEM

- A large share of tickets are routine, repetitive, and self-resolvable.
- Legacy systems consume the budget just to keep running.
- Mean time to resolution drags as queues build.
- Skilled engineers are pulled onto tier-1 work.

\$100B+ annual federal IT spend; ~80% on operations & maintenance (GAO, 2025)

11 critical legacy systems flagged; most on outdated languages (GAO)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1** Answer the question
- 2** Resolve safe cases
- 3** Prepare the runbook
-  Approver runs high-risk (*human gate*)
- 5** Record & audit

Low-risk is automated; privileged change requires an entitled approver. The desk role can't self-authorize.

THE ROI

75% of queries resolved by the assistant itself, IBM AskIT (133k+ users)

>10% MTTR reduction with ServiceNow ITSM AI/ML (Microsoft internal)

+34% productivity for novice agents with a gen-AI copilot (QJE 2025)

Executive case: Deflecting the routine three-quarters of tickets returns skilled engineering hours to incidents and modernization — the work that actually reduces the 80% legacy-operations tax. The newest staff get the biggest boost, shortening ramp and cutting turnover cost.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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Data protection — PII masking before inference; KMS encryption; S3 Object Lock (WORM) audit; private VPC + Bedrock VPC endpoint.

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Deploy: Standalone (own VPC/edge/identity/data/WORM audit) or + Whole-of-Government layer. Full CloudFormation + Terraform parity, commercial & GovCloud (US).

Public Safety & Public Health Agent

FROM 4 HOURS TO 5 MINUTES

An agent that accelerates the labor-intensive front end of public-health and public-safety work — identifying sites, triaging data, and drafting documentation — so experts spend their time deciding, not searching. Findings and reports are always human-reviewed.

THE PROBLEM

- Identifying sites of interest is slow, manual, and image-heavy.
- Investigations race a clock while staff comb through data.
- Documentation burden pulls specialists off the field.
- Surge events overwhelm fixed expert capacity.

4 hours to manually identify cooling towers per area before AI (CDC)

12+ outbreak investigations across 8 states needing faster triage (CDC)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1 Detect sites of interest
- 2 Triage the data
- 3 Draft documentation
- ✓ Human reviews (*human gate*)
- 5 Record & audit

The agent accelerates detection and drafting; an expert validates and approves. Findings are never auto-published.

THE ROI

-98% cooling-tower identification time, CDC TowerScout (4 hr → 5 min)

~600x faster site identification per area, CDC TowerScout

Half report-writing time in a vendor police trial (evidence is mixed — see notes)

Executive case: When the front-end search collapses from hours to minutes, scarce experts investigate more, faster, during the window that matters most in an outbreak — without ceding a single judgment to the model. Lead with the government, peer-reviewed proof point; treat document-drafting claims as promising but contested.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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Whole-of-Government Orchestration Platform

FROM 50 SILOS TO ONE GOVERNED LAYER

A shared platform that gives every agent governed tool access, canonical data, durable cross-agency workflow coordination, and a compliance event trail — so a resident's life event is handled once, across agencies, with consent and audit built in. The hard part isn't the agents; it's governing what they're allowed to do.

THE PROBLEM

- GenAI pilots are everywhere; funded, governed production is rare.
- Each agency builds its own tool access, identity and audit — inconsistently.
- Legacy systems and siloed data block cross-agency service.
- Residents repeat themselves to every agency for one life event.

90% vs 25% piloting GenAI vs. funded to scale it — the pilot trap (NASCIO 2025)

\$100B+ annual government IT spend, ~80% operating legacy systems (GAO)

THE GOVERNED SOLUTION

- 1** Govern tool access
- 2** Canonical data
- 3** Coordinate the saga
-  **Human gates** (*human gate*)
- 5** Compliance events

Five declarative life-event templates (moving, job loss, new business, disaster, bereavement) run on this layer.

THE ROI

FedRAMP High Bedrock + Guardrails + KBs authorized; DoD IL-4/5 in GovCloud

8 agents in this library already run on the same governed layer

5 life events moving, job loss, new business, disaster, bereavement — declarative

Executive case: Build the governance once and every future agent inherits identity, least privilege, canonical data, audit and human gates on day one. That's how a CIO escapes the pilot trap: not more pilots, but a paved road to funded, compliant production — and a resident experience that finally feels like one government.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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